This will make a reasonable political solution very difficult, because most Israelis consider Hamas and Palestinians to be one and the same. In my mind, the stage-by-stage creation of a Palestinian state that will coexist peacefully alongside Israel is the only reasonable long-term solution. It is an opinion that I have held for many years. After this latest Hamas onslaught, many Israelis may point not only to the fact that Hamas are Palestinians, but also that many Palestinians have expressed some form of contentment at Hamas's "achievement," proving that they all want our death and the eradication of Israel, and making any type of peaceful coexistence impossible. That is why I allude to a stage-by-stage process. No doubt the Palestinians will have to get used to the advantages of coexistence and not pay attention to the daily attempts to add more Jewish settlements on the land allocated to them, as was the case under our disastrous coalition government. But back to the immediate events.

In an unusually warm and supportive speech today, President Biden expressed his horror at Hamas's atrocities and reaffirmed America's full support of Israel. The *USS Gerald R. Ford*, the most modern aircraft carrier in the US Navy, is now sailing near Israel's shores with 5,000 marines on board, ready to intervene if needed. Additionally, the first US plane with sophisticated ammunition landed in Israel.

It seems that on the northern border we are also at war. The overall number of Israelis killed is now estimated at 1,200.

Wednesday, October 11

War cabinet established. Gantz is a member, and a slot has been kept for Lapid. Otherwise, the situation remains chaotic, with ongoing uncertainty about the North: will Hezbollah join Hamas or prudently decide to stay on the sidelines? Apparently, some gliders have penetrated Galilee from Lebanon; planes are searching for them. After two hours, however, it was